RDG-P5 · PRÁCTICA 03

Multiple choice

Hoja 03 · Reseña · dificultad 3 de 4

6 preguntas (31–36) · 2 puntos por pregunta · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read a review of an exhibition. For questions 31–36, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) which you think fits best according to the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

All at sea

Our critic spends an afternoon inside a painting – or something like one

The queue, when I arrived on a wet Thursday afternoon, stretched round the corner of the old bonded warehouse in which Turner: Into the Light has made its home. This is not, I should say at once, a complaint. Queues for art are a rare enough sight that one is inclined to cheer them, and the people in this one – families with damp toddlers, couples on what looked like early dates, a party of pensioners from Kent – were plainly in good spirits. Several, I gathered, had come on the recommendation of friends, which is more than can be said for most of the exhibitions I review. Whatever else one says about the show, and I shall say a good deal, it has persuaded thousands of people who would not normally cross the threshold of a gallery to part with thirty pounds for the privilege of standing in the dark.

For that is, in essence, what one does. The 'experience', as its makers insist on calling it, consists of a single vast room onto whose walls and floor are projected animated versions of some forty of Turner's paintings, accompanied by an orchestral soundtrack of considerable volume. Ships list and burn; storm clouds swirl across the ceiling; at one point a locomotive appears to charge straight at the audience, prompting a small boy beside me to seize his father's sleeve. The whole cycle lasts thirty-five minutes, after which it begins again, and visitors are free to stay for as long as their tolerance for kettledrums allows.

It would be churlish to deny that some of this is impressive. The technicians have clearly studied the paintings with care, and there are moments – the slow dissolve of a Venetian sunset into the grey light of the Thames, for instance – when the effect is genuinely lovely. Nor is there anything new in the urge to animate the work of a painter so preoccupied with movement. Turner himself, who is said to have had himself lashed to a ship's mast in order to observe a storm, would very probably have been intrigued by the technology, if not by the use to which it has been put.

The trouble is that, for all its ambition, the show is curiously incurious about what made Turner worth animating in the first place. A Turner seascape is not exciting because things happen in it; it is exciting because so little is fixed. The edges of objects dissolve, the horizon wavers, and the eye is never quite sure where the sea ends and the sky begins. That uncertainty is the point, and it requires something of the viewer: time, stillness, a willingness to go on looking until the picture begins to look back. Here, everything is decided for us. The clouds move because they have been told to, the waves break on cue, and the music informs us, at regular intervals, that we are feeling awe.

There is, admittedly, a panel of text at the entrance, setting out the main facts of Turner's life in a dozen sentences, and a gift shop at the exit selling umbrellas printed with The Fighting Temeraire. Between the two, however, there is very little that might be called information, and nothing at all that might be called a painting. Visitors hoping to learn how Turner achieved his effects, or why his contemporaries found them so shocking, will leave knowing roughly what they knew when they came in, though they will at least be drier.

None of this would matter very much if the show presented itself as what it is: a pleasant, rather loud entertainment loosely inspired by a great painter. What grates is the claim, repeated on every poster, that it offers a way of seeing Turner ‘as never before’. In one sense this is perfectly true. Never before, surely, has his work been seen at this size, at this volume or with this much dry ice. But the implication – that the original canvases are somehow inadequate, and need rescuing from their frames – is one that ought to be resisted.

It is worth adding, for those who emerge feeling that something was missing, that several hundred of Turner’s paintings, watercolours and sketches belong to Tate Britain, a short bus ride away, where the permanent collection can be seen without charge. The rooms there are quiet, the lighting is unremarkable and nothing moves at all. I went the following morning, partly out of duty and partly to clear my head. There were perhaps a dozen other visitors, most of them standing very still. I stayed for two hours, and I would not have missed it for thirty pounds.

31 What is the writer's attitude to the queue in the first paragraph?

A He takes it as proof of the exhibition's artistic value.
B He welcomes it, while hinting that he has doubts about the show.
C He finds it irritating, despite the good humour of those in it.
D He sees it as evidence that galleries usually charge too little.

32 What does the writer imply about the soundtrack in the second paragraph?

A It was too loud to be enjoyed for very long.
B It frightened the younger members of the audience.
C It was the most impressive feature of the show.
D It bore little relation to the paintings on display.

33 In the third paragraph, the writer mentions the story of Turner being tied to a mast in order to

A cast doubt on a famous story about Turner's methods.
B show how much risk Turner was prepared to take for his art.
C argue that Turner would have approved of the exhibition.
D suggest that the show's basic idea is not alien to Turner.

34 According to the writer, what is the main weakness of the show?

A It includes too few of Turner's paintings.
B It reproduces the colours of the originals poorly.
C It leaves no room for the viewer's own response.
D It concentrates too heavily on Turner's life.

35 What point is the writer making when he says that visitors 'will at least be drier'?

A The venue offers welcome shelter from bad weather.
B The show gives visitors little beyond a dry place to stand.
C Visitors would be wise to buy an umbrella in the gift shop.
D The show is best visited on a wet afternoon.

36 Which of the following best summarises the writer's view of the exhibition?

A It is an enjoyable spectacle that misses what makes Turner remarkable.
B It is a serious attempt to bring Turner to a new audience.
C It is a cynical commercial venture with nothing to recommend it.
D It is a technical failure that does the original paintings very little justice.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta. Al corregir, 2 puntos por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
31	A	B	C	D	/ 2
32	A	B	C	D	/ 2
33	A	B	C	D	/ 2
34	A	B	C	D	/ 2
35	A	B	C	D	/ 2
36	A	B	C	D	/ 2
				Total	**/ 12**

Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

2 puntos por acierto. Cada solución indica el pasaje, una respuesta propia como la que pide el método (§2.2), por qué la clave es correcta y por qué falla cada distractor, con su tipo (§7) y la cita del texto que lo descarta. Los números de sección remiten a RDG-P5_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Tipo de pregunta	Distractores	Teoría
31	**B**	Opinión y actitud	A §7.5 · C §7.5 · D §7.1/7.7	§4.2 · §4.3
32	**A**	Implicación	B §7.1/7.5 · C §7.7/7.8 · D §7.7	§4.3 · §3.2
33	**D**	Propósito	A §7.1/7.2 · B §7.2 · C §7.6	§5.1 · §4.3
34	**C**	Detalle	A §7.7 · B §7.7 · D §7.5/7.8	§6.2 · §4.3
35	**B**	Significado en contexto	A §7.2 · C §7.1 · D §7.7	§3.4 · §4.3
36	**A**	Global	B §7.6 · C §7.3 · D §7.5	§5.4 · §4.4

Explicación por pregunta

31 · B · Opinión y actitud

Pregunta: What is the writer's attitude to the queue in the first paragraph?

Pasaje: párrafo 1. **Respuesta propia:** Le parece bien que haya cola, pero ya deja ver que la exposición no le convence.

A He takes it as proof of the exhibition's artistic value.
Falla (lógica §7.5). El autor separa la cola del valor de la exposición: celebra que atraiga a gente nueva (who would not normally cross the threshold of a gallery), no lo que ofrece.

B He welcomes it, while hinting that he has doubts about the show.
Correcta. Lo dice expresamente (This is not, I should say at once, a complaint; one is inclined to cheer them), pero deja caer reservas: Whatever else one says about the show, and I shall say a good deal, y la ironía final, for the privilege of standing in the dark.

C He finds it irritating, despite the good humour of those in it.
Falla (lógica §7.5). Invierte la postura del autor: This is not, I should say at once, a complaint.

D He sees it as evidence that galleries usually charge too little.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, ausente §7.7). Toma thirty pounds y le da un sentido que el texto no tiene: no hay ninguna comparación con lo que cobran las galerías.

Teoría: §4.2 Marcadores de postura · §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

32 · A · Implicación

Pregunta: What does the writer imply about the soundtrack in the second paragraph?

Pasaje: párrafo 2. **Respuesta propia:** Que estaba tan alta que costaba aguantarla mucho rato.

A It was too loud to be enjoyed for very long.
Correcta. Dos marcas de understatement e ironía (§4.3): la música es of considerable volume, y la gente puede quedarse as long as their tolerance for kettledrums allows. Tolerance presenta la música como algo que se soporta, no como algo que se disfruta.

B It frightened the younger members of the audience.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, lógica §7.5). Lo que asusta al niño es la locomotora (a locomotive appears to charge straight at the audience), no la música.

C It was the most impressive feature of the show.
Falla (ausente §7.7, pasaje vecino §7.8). El párrafo no elogia nada; el único momento que el autor alaba está en el párrafo siguiente (genuinely lovely) y es visual.

D It bore little relation to the paintings on display.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto no dice que la música no encaje con las imágenes; lo que señala es su volumen (of considerable volume).

Teoría: §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión · §3.2 De dónde sale una inferencia

33 · D · Propósito

Pregunta: In the third paragraph, the writer mentions the story of Turner being tied to a mast in order to

Pasaje: párrafo 3. **Respuesta propia:** Para conceder que animar a Turner no es una idea absurda: a él le interesaba el movimiento.

A cast doubt on a famous story about Turner's methods.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, no responde §7.2). La fórmula is said to have es una cautela del autor, no la función del fragmento: no discute si la historia es cierta.

B show how much risk Turner was prepared to take for his art.
Falla (no responde §7.2). Es una lectura posible de la anécdota, pero no su función en el párrafo, que es explicar por qué tiene sentido animar a un pintor so preoccupied with movement.

C argue that Turner would have approved of the exhibition.
Falla (medio cierto §7.6). Medio cierto: le habría intrigado la técnica, if not by the use to which it has been put.

D suggest that the show's basic idea is not alien to Turner.
Correcta. Es un párrafo de concesión (It would be churlish to deny that some of this is impressive). La idea de animar a un pintor so preoccupied with movement no es nueva, y la anécdota lo apoya: a Turner le habría interesado la técnica (would very probably have been intrigued by the technology). La reserva llega al final de la frase.

Teoría: §5.1 Para qué sirve un fragmento · §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

34 · C · Detalle

Pregunta: According to the writer, what is the main weakness of the show?

Pasaje: párrafo 4. **Respuesta propia:** Que lo decide todo por el espectador: no le deja mirar ni sentir por su cuenta.

A It includes too few of Turner's paintings.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El número de cuadros solo aparece como dato (some forty of Turner's paintings); el autor no lo critica.

B It reproduces the colours of the originals poorly.
Falla (ausente §7.7). Lo contradice el párrafo anterior: The technicians have clearly studied the paintings with care.

C It leaves no room for the viewer's own response.
Correcta. Un Turner exige algo del espectador (it requires something of the viewer), y aquí no se le deja hacer nada: Here, everything is decided for us. El remate irónico lo confirma: la música informs us, at regular intervals, that we are feeling awe.

D It concentrates too heavily on Turner's life.
Falla (lógica §7.5, pasaje vecino §7.8). Es al revés: la biografía se despacha en a dozen sentences, y el autor se queja de la falta de información, no de su exceso.

Teoría: §6.2 Lo concreto del texto, lo abstracto de la opción · §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

35 · B · Significado en contexto

Pregunta: What point is the writer making when he says that visitors 'will at least be drier'?

Pasaje: párrafo 5. **Respuesta propia:** Que lo único que se gana con la visita es no mojarse.

A The venue offers welcome shelter from bad weather.
Falla (no responde §7.2). Es la lectura literal: es cierto que estarán más secos, pero lo que el autor quiere decir es que no habrán aprendido nada (knowing roughly what they knew when they came in).

B The show gives visitors little beyond a dry place to stand.
Correcta. Es ironía (§4.3). La frase completa dice que el público saldrá knowing roughly what they knew when they came in; at least presenta como único beneficio el haberse resguardado de la lluvia con la que empieza la reseña (a wet Thursday afternoon).

C Visitors would be wise to buy an umbrella in the gift shop.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1). Junta los paraguas de la tienda (umbrellas printed with The Fighting Temeraire) con la lluvia, pero el autor no recomienda comprar nada.

D The show is best visited on a wet afternoon.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto no aconseja cuándo ir; la lluvia solo sirve para la ironía (though they will at least be drier).

Teoría: §3.4 Significado en contexto · §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

36 · A · Global

Pregunta: Which of the following best summarises the writer's view of the exhibition?

Pasaje: el texto completo. **Respuesta propia:** Un espectáculo agradable que se pierde lo esencial de Turner.

A It is an enjoyable spectacle that misses what makes Turner remarkable.
Correcta. El autor concede lo agradable (genuinely lovely; a pleasant, rather loud entertainment loosely inspired by a great painter), pero su crítica central es que la exposición ignora lo que hace grande a Turner: the show is curiously incurious about what made Turner worth animating in the first place.

B It is a serious attempt to bring Turner to a new audience.
Falla (medio cierto §7.6). Atraer público nuevo es un mérito que el autor reconoce (who would not normally cross the threshold of a gallery), pero no la considera un esfuerzo serio por acercar a Turner: el público sale knowing roughly what they knew when they came in.

C It is a cynical commercial venture with nothing to recommend it.
Falla (alcance §7.3). Exagera: el autor admite momentos genuinely lovely y la llama a pleasant, rather loud entertainment.

D It is a technical failure that does the original paintings very little justice.
Falla (lógica §7.5). El autor elogia la ejecución técnica (The technicians have clearly studied the paintings with care); su crítica va contra el planteamiento, no contra la técnica.

Teoría: §5.4 Preguntas globales · §4.4 Léxico de actitud en las opciones